

WEEKLY JOURNAL DIGEST

Weekly journal digest for 2026-06-01 to 2026-06-07

Curated articles in political communication and computational social science.

SUMMARY

COMAP Journal Bot reviewed 239 collected candidates for the 2026-06-01 to 2026-06-07 digest window. After manual relevance filtering, the curated digest keeps 39 papers: 14 new this week, 25 previous-week catch-up items, and 0 late additions.

The new material is leaner than the previous two weeks but sharply useful: autocratic election demand in Russia, causal inference under post-treatment selection, democratic risks in internet architecture, remote-work isolation, and several policy-facing climate and public-health studies. The catch-up section remains rich for COMAP priorities, especially platform data access, algorithmic visibility in political search, social-media feed redesign during an election, AI-assisted reproducibility work, and the diffusion of LLMs through published scholarship.

- Authoritarian information control appears through election removal under autocracy and democratic-risk arguments about internet infrastructure.
- AI-for-computational-social-science items focus on reproducibility, adoption measurement, and human-AI interaction rather than general hype.
- The policy thread is unusually broad: climate inequality, wildfire evacuation risk, energy transition strategy, food policy, conservation equity, and urban well-being.

HIGHLIGHTS

The demand for elections under autocracy: Regime approval and the elimination of local elections in Russia

AMERICAN JOURNAL OF POLITICAL SCIENCE · 2026-06-03

Quintin H. Beazer; Noah Buckley; Ora John Reuter

Why it matters · This is the clearest authoritarian-politics article in the new window: it uses two decades of Russian public opinion data to test whether citizens punish the removal of local elections.

[Open article →](#)

The architecture of the internet creates risks for democracy

SCIENCE · 2026-06-04

Stephan Lewandowsky

Why it matters · A direct fit for platform governance and democratic resilience, with the internet treated as political infrastructure rather than neutral plumbing.

[Open article →](#)

Post-Treatment Problems: What Can We Say about the Effect of a Treatment among Sub-Groups Who (Would) Respond in Some Way?

POLITICAL ANALYSIS · 2026-06-02

Chad Hazlett; Nina McMurry; Tanvi Shinkre

Why it matters · A useful causal-inference contribution for political methodology and computational social science, especially for designs that condition on responses observed after treatment.

[Open article →](#)

Home alone: Remote work, isolation, and mental health

SCIENCE · 2026-06-04

Natalia Emanuel; Emma Harrington; Amanda Pallais

Why it matters · The paper brings large-scale evidence to a post-pandemic communication problem: how remote work changes isolation, well-being, and social contact.

[Open article →](#)

Climate change, inequality, and childhood stunting in African countries

PROCEEDINGS OF THE NATIONAL ACADEMY OF SCIENCES · 2026-06-01

Nabin Pradhan; Elizabeth Ludwig-Borycz; Arun Agrawal

Why it matters · A strong inequality-and-policy piece linking climate exposure, socioeconomic inequality, and child development across African countries.

[Open article →](#)

Resetting population mobility responses under repeated nonpharmaceutical interventions: Implications for hypothesized pandemic fatigue

PROCEEDINGS OF THE NATIONAL ACADEMY OF SCIENCES · 2026-06-01

Albano Rikani; Laura Di Domenico; Chiara E. Sabbatini; Victor Navarro; Leo Ferres; et al. (7 total)

Why it matters · This is valuable for public-behavior measurement because it separates different temporal channels behind compliance fatigue during repeated restrictions.

[Open article →](#)

Moving Targets, Moving Politics: The State of Play in Social Media Data Access

POLITICAL COMMUNICATION · 2026-05-30

Claes H. de Vreese; Rebekah Tromble

Why it matters · Platform data access remains a central constraint on computational political communication; this piece is directly relevant to research infrastructure and governance.

[Open article →](#)

AI-assisted teams outperform AI-led teams but not human-only teams in assessing research reproducibility in quantitative social science

PROCEEDINGS OF THE NATIONAL ACADEMY OF SCIENCES · 2026-05-28

Abel Brodeur; David Valenta; Alexandru Marcoci; Juan P. Aparicio; Derek Mikola; et al. (272 total)

Why it matters · A concrete AI-for-CSS benchmark: it tests where LLM assistance helps, fails, and still needs expert human judgment in reproducibility work.

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- Nature
- Nature Human Behaviour
- Nature Machine Intelligence
- Nature Communications
- Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences
- Science
- Science Advances

COLLECTION SNAPSHOT

TOTAL COLLECTED CANDIDATES 239	NEW THIS WEEK CANDIDATES 77	PREVIOUS WEEK CATCH-UP CANDIDATES 162
LATE ADDITIONS CANDIDATES 0	CURATED DIGEST BELOW 14 new, 25 catch-up, 0 late additions	NOTE The full collected set above is before manual relevance filtering, while the HTML email body, attached full HTML artifact, and attached PDF reflect the curated digest.

FULL CURATED DIGEST

New This Week

American Journal of Political Science

The demand for elections under autocracy: Regime approval and the elimination of local elections in Russia

2026-06-03 · DOI 10.1111/AJPS.70060

Quintin H. Beazer; Noah Buckley; Ora John Reuter

Assistant Professor, Department of Political Science Trinity College Dublin Dublin Ireland; Associate Professor, Department of Political Science Florida State University Tallahassee Florida USA; Professor, Department of Political Science University of Wisconsin-Milwaukee Bolton, Milwaukee Wisconsin USA

Abstract. Abstract Most contemporary autocracies hold elections. Does the public value these elections? If so, do they value them enough to punish incumbents that subvert elections? We examine this question in contemporary Russia, examining whether individuals withdraw support from regime leaders when local elections are eliminated. Over the past 25 years, most Russian cities have replaced their directly elected mayors with appointed executives. This paper uses the largest data set on public opinion ever assembled on Russia-over 400,000 responses drawn from two decades by Russia's top polling agencies-to analyze how the elimination of elections in Russia's large cities has affected public attitudes toward the authorities. Using a difference-in-differences design, we find that election cancellation reduces support for President Vladimir Putin. This effect is stronger in settings with histories of robust electoral competition. This suggests that the public is more likely to punish incumbents for eliminating elections when individuals have experience with competitive elections.

[Read article →](#)

Political Analysis

Post-Treatment Problems: What Can We Say about the Effect of a Treatment among Sub-Groups Who (Would) Respond in Some Way?

2026-06-02 · DOI 10.1017/PAN.2026.10047

Chad Hazlett; Nina McMurry; Tanvi Shinkre

UCLA; Vanderbilt University

Abstract. Abstract Investigators are often interested in how a treatment affects an outcome for units responding to treatment in a certain way. We may wish to know the effect among units that, for example, meaningfully implemented an intervention, passed an attention check or demonstrated some important mechanistic response. Simply conditioning on the observed value of the post-treatment variable introduces problematic biases. Further, the identification assumptions required by several existing strategies are often indefensible. We propose the treatment reactive average causal effect (TRACE), which we define as the total effect of treatment in the group that, if treated, would realize a particular value of the relevant post-treatment variable. By reasoning about the effect among the "non-reactive" group, we can identify and estimate the range of plausible values for the TRACE. We demonstrate the use of this approach with three examples: (i) learning the effect of police-perceived race on police violence during traffic stops, a case where point identification may be possible; (ii) estimating effects of a community policing intervention in Liberia, in communities that meaningfully implemented it; and (iii) studying how in-person canvassing affects support for transgender rights, among participants for whom the intervention would result in more positive feelings toward transgender people.

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Science

Fires reverse progress toward ozone air quality standards in the United States

2026-06-04 · DOI 10.1126/SCIENCE.AED3197

Weizhi Deng; Jun Wang; Meng Zhou; Xi Chen; Xiaodong Wu; Huanxin Zhang; Jason B. Cohen; Jing Wei; Arlindo da Silva; Guy P. Brasseur; Claire Granier; Laurence Rouil

Atmospheric Chemistry Observations and Modeling Laboratory, National Center for Atmospheric Research, Boulder, CO, USA.; Chemical Sciences Laboratory, NOAA/CIRES, University of Colorado, Boulder, CO, USA.; Copernicus Atmospheric Monitoring Service, European Centre for Medium-Range Weather Forecasts, Bonn, Germany.; Department of Atmospheric and Oceanic Science, Earth System Science Interdisciplinary Center, University of Maryland, College Park, MD, USA.; Department of Chemical and Biochemical Engineering, The University of Iowa, Iowa City, IA, USA.; Department of Electrical and Computer Engineering, The University of Iowa, Iowa City, IA, USA.; Environmental Modeling Group, Max Planck Institute for Meteorology, Hamburg, Germany.; Global Modeling and Assimilation Office, NASA Goddard Space Flight Center, Greenbelt, MD, USA.; et al. (10 total)

Abstract. Recent surges in wildfire emissions have exacerbated surface ozone pollution in the United States. Using deep learning, we developed a gapless daily surface ozone dataset at 1-kilometer resolution for 2003-2024. This dataset revealed a reversal in national policy-relevant ozone trends that had gone undetected by the sparse monitoring network: from 0.65 parts per billion (ppb) per year (2003-2015) to +0.13 ppb per year (2015-2024). The reversal was primarily driven by increasing wildfire emissions, offsetting 3.9 years of mitigation progress. Premature deaths from fire-sourced ozone have increased by 318 deaths per year since 2013, with post-2013 mortality 46% higher than pre-2013 mortality. During 2022-2024, wildfire emissions exposed 43 million people to nonattainment conditions, effectively preventing a 4-ppb tightening of the ozone standard. These results underscore the growing challenges of sustaining air quality progress as wildfires intensify under climate change.

[Read article →](#)**Home alone: Remote work, isolation, and mental health**

2026-06-04 · DOI 10.1126/SCIENCE.AEC7671

Natalia Emanuel; Emma Harrington; Amanda Pallais

Department of Economics, Harvard University, Cambridge, MA, USA.; Department of Economics, University of Virginia, Charlottesville, VA, USA.; Research Department, Federal Reserve Bank of New York, New York, NY, USA.

Abstract. How does remote work affect isolation and mental health? We drew on five nationally representative surveys of American workers (N = 588,322) conducted from 2011 to 2024, omitting the peak pandemic years of 2020-2021. Our difference-in-differences approach compared changes in mental health among people in remotable jobs—who experienced a large and persistent rise in remote work since COVID-19—to people in nonremotable jobs, where remote work increased far less. We found that remote work increases time spent alone, worsens mental well-being across multiple measures, and increases the use of mental health services and prescriptions. These effects were concentrated among individuals living alone. We estimate that the rise of remote work explains about a third of the increase in isolation and mental distress between 2011-2019 and 2022-2024.

[Read article →](#)**Landscape efficiency frontiers for biodiversity, climate mitigation, and net economic value**

2026-06-04 · DOI 10.1126/SCIENCE.AEA9058

Stephen Polasky; Peter L. Hawthorne; Rebecca Chaplin-Kramer; Jeffrey Smith; James S. Gerber; Saleh Mamun; Mary Ruckelshaus; Jason Russ; Rafael Schmitt; Adrian L. Vogl; Adam C. Castonguay; James Douglass; et al. (30 total)

Beyond Petrochemicals, Resources Legacy Fund, Sacramento, CA, USA.; Commonwealth Scientific and Industrial Research Organization (CSIRO), St. Lucia, QLD, Australia.; Department of Agricultural, Environmental and Development Economics, Ohio State University,

Columbus, OH, USA.; Department of Applied Economics, University of Minnesota, St. Paul, MN, USA.; Department of Biology, Stanford University, Stanford, CA, USA.; Department of Ecology, Evolution, and Behavior, University of Minnesota, St. Paul, MN, USA.; Environmental Studies, University of California Santa Barbara, Santa Barbara, CA, USA.; Global Science, World Wildlife Fund (WWF), San Francisco, CA, USA.; et al. (19 total)

Abstract. National governments and multilateral institutions face difficult challenges reconciling biodiversity, climate, and economic development goals. We integrated spatial biophysical and economic data with optimization methods to develop sustainable landscape efficiency frontiers that show maximally feasible combinations of biodiversity conservation, land-based climate mitigation, and net economic value from agricultural crops, livestock, and forestry production. We applied this approach in 146 countries and found large potential gains in biodiversity, climate, and economic development from improved land use and land management. Summing national-level results shows the potential to increase climate mitigation by more than 200 billion metric tons of CO₂ equivalents (>20% increase) or net economic value by more than US\$350 billion (>80% increase), without loss in other objectives.

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The architecture of the internet creates risks for democracy

2026-06-04 · DOI 10.1126/SCIENCE.AEI2409

Stephan Lewandowsky

Stephan Lewandowsky is a chair in cognitive science at the School of Psychological Science, University of Bristol, Bristol, UK, and an honorary professor in the Department of Psychology, University of Potsdam, Potsdam, Germany.

Abstract. Abstract unavailable.

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Nature

The future of science communication is not an article like this

2026-06-02 · DOI 10.1038/D41586-026-01723-1

Abstract. Abstract unavailable.

[Read article →](#)

Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences

Climate change, inequality, and childhood stunting in African countries

2026-06-01 · DOI 10.1073/PNAS.2518179123

Nabin Pradhan; Elizabeth Ludwig-Borycz; Arun Agrawal

Center for Global Health Equity, Michigan Medicine, University of Michigan; Just Transformations to Sustainability Initiative, University of Notre Dame; Pulte Institute for Global Development, Keough School of Global Affairs, University of Notre Dame

Abstract. Childhood stunting is associated with increased mortality, higher risk of chronic disease, impaired cognitive development, lower educational attainment, reduced economic opportunities, and intergenerational transmission of stunting. These risks are likely to intensify as climate change exacerbates key drivers of undernutrition, making it important to understand how rising temperatures affect stunting and the role of socioeconomic inequality in this relationship. We analyze data from 34 African countries from 2004 to 2020 using Demographic and Health Surveys (DHS), combining observed temperature variability from ERA5 reanalysis with anthropogenic temperature anomalies derived from Detection and Attribution Model Intercomparison Project (DAMIP) simulations. Using a mediation framework, we examine pathways linking temperature anomalies, inequality, and child stunting. Results based on observed temperature anomalies show no direct

climate effect on stunting or inequality, but a positive and statistically significant association between inequality and stunting. In contrast, anthropogenic temperature anomalies are positively associated with inequality and stunting, with a 1 C increase linked to a 3.45% rise in child stunting (SE = 1.52, P = 0.023), with no evidence of mediation through inequality. Notably, we find a consistent positive association between inequality and stunting across specifications. These findings suggest that reducing inequality, together with investments in education, sanitation, and household resilience, could substantially lower stunting rates and protect child health in a warming world.

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Egress thresholds and wildfire fatalities

2026-06-01 · DOI 10.1073/PNAS.2535081123

Caitlin R. Fong; Carlo W. Broderick; Max A. Moritz; Benjamin S. Halpern

Bren School of Environmental Science, University of California Santa Barbara; National Center for Ecological Analysis and Synthesis, University of California Santa Barbara; University of California Cooperative Extension

Abstract. Avoiding human fatalities during wildfires is a key public policy objective. Outward road access, or the number of egress routes, is widely assumed to influence wildfire fatalities, yet few studies have quantified if or when this factor becomes critical. To address this gap, we assembled a dataset on community-level wildfire fatality counts and combined it with nationally consistent community egress for the United States, finding that cumulative fatalities are sharply concentrated in communities with very few exits, declining steeply to roughly six nonresidential roads, beyond which additional routes confer minimal further risk reduction. Extending this analysis nationally, we mapped all small communities (

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Impacts of future sea level change on Greenland from community knowledge, coastal mapping, and glacial isostatic adjustment models

2026-06-01 · DOI 10.1073/PNAS.2528615123

Kirsty J. Tinto; Jacqueline Austermann; Robin E. Bell; David Blockley; Casey E. Brayton; Diana Krawczyk; Lauren Lewright; Andrew J. Lloyd; Frank O. Nitsche; Guy J. G. Paxman; David F. Porter; Aqqaaluk Srensen; et al. (14 total)

Department of Earth and Environmental Sciences, Columbia University; Department of Environment and Minerals, Greenland Institute of Natural Resources; Department of Geography, Durham University; Greenland Climate Research Centre, Greenland Institute of Natural Resources; Marine and Polar Geophysics Division, Lamont-Doherty Earth Observatory, Columbia University; Seismology, Geology and Tectonophysics Division, Lamont-Doherty Earth Observatory, Columbia University

Abstract. Making predictions of global change relevant to individual communities is a critical challenge, especially where local impacts diverge from global predictions. While sea level is rising globally, in Greenland, sea level is predicted to fall over the coming century due to land rebound and sea surface lowering, consequences of glacial isostatic adjustment from both past and future ice loss. Here we present results of a US and Greenland scientific partnership, working with the community of Aasiaat, West Greenland, to identify the impacts of future sea level change where sea level is projected to fall 0.41 to 0.93 m by 2100 CE. Through collaboratively designed, conducted, and interpreted multibeam bathymetry surveys combined with targeted glacial isostatic adjustment models, we identify areas that will be most impacted by sea level fall. We identify two shallow channels where disruption to navigation and nutrient cycles will occur when water level falls beneath critical depth thresholds. To make these predictions useful we established communication pathways to share findings effectively across a broad array of interest groups by engaging with community members, government officials, and students. This multipronged approach of collaboratively designed observations, locally targeted impact modeling and integrated formal and informal communication can be expanded to coastal communities facing environmental challenges around the world.

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Resetting population mobility responses under repeated nonpharmaceutical interventions: Implications for hypothesized pandemic fatigue

2026-06-01 · DOI 10.1073/PNAS.2533284123

Albano Rikani; Laura Di Domenico; Chiara E. Sabbatini; Victor Navarro; Leo Ferres; Jocelyn Raude; Vittoria Colizza

Faculty of Engineering, Universidad del Desarrollo; Institute for Scientific Interchange Foundation; Institute of Social and Preventive Medicine, University of Bern; Sorbonne Universite, INSERM, Pierre Louis Institute of Epidemiology and Public Health; Telefonica; Ecole des hautes etudes en sante publique, CNRS, Inserm, Arenes-UMR 6051, Recherche sur les Services et Management en Sante-U 1309, Universite de Rennes

Abstract. Nonpharmaceutical interventions (NPIs) are essential for controlling infectious diseases during prevaccine periods, yet their success hinges on sustained population behavioral responses to restrictions. This study investigates how mobility responses to tiered restriction systems evolved over time during COVID-19 in six geographical regions across Europe, North America, Africa, and South America. Using daily mobility data and linear-mixed models, we characterized three temporal dimensions shaping these responses: cumulative exposure to restrictions, time spent under a given tier, and repeated reintroduction of the same tier. Time spent under a given tier caused the most rapid attenuation of mobility reduction, producing effects within days that cumulative exposure, required months of restrictions to achieve. Iterative application of shorter NPIs, interspersed with temporary relaxation, was associated with a restoration of mobility responses when restrictions were reintroduced, mitigating attenuation and sometimes even strengthening responses. These patterns are consistent with mechanisms discussed under the umbrella of pandemic fatigue, whereby temporary relaxation may provide psychological relief and a sense of regained autonomy that can renew public willingness to respond to restrictions when reintroduced, while remaining compatible with behavioral adjustment and structural constraints. However, they are also compatible with alternative explanations, including behavioral adaptation, structural constraints on mobility, or evolving interpretations of restrictions. These findings emphasize the dual benefits of short, strategic NPIs for epidemic control and public resilience, offering actionable insights for designing more sustainable pandemic interventions.

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Resolving Feynman's restaurant problem reveals optimal solutions and human strategies

2026-06-01 · DOI 10.1073/PNAS.2509612123

Brian Christian; Evan M. Russek; Thomas L. Griffiths

Department of Computer Science, Princeton University; Department of Experimental Psychology, University of Oxford; Department of Psychology, Hunter College, City University of New York; Department of Psychology, Princeton University

Abstract. In the 1970s, physicist Richard Feynman turned lunch with a friend into a math problem-how to optimize dish selection over multiple meals-but his handwritten notes remained a mystery for decades. Here we present the fully deciphered problem and solution, prove its optimality, generalize it to related problems, and compare the results to human behavior. The optimal policy specifies decreasing thresholds for switching from exploring new dishes to exploiting the best, with thresholds varying based on the distribution of the quality of dishes. We connect these results to the existing psychological literature on optimal stopping problems, which has explored close variants on Feynman's problem, and use our generalization of the solution to explore how the underlying distribution of the quality of the options influences people's choices. A preregistered experiment with 2,520 participants shows that people adopt thresholds that decrease linearly with the proportion of trials remaining, consistent with the observation of linear thresholds in other optimal stopping problems. However, we show that people tend to explore more than predicted by linear thresholds, and that different distributions of quality result in thresholds with the same slope but different intercepts. These results indicate that people adapt linear thresholds used in optimal stopping tasks in a way that is sensitive to the underlying distribution-a simple strategy that we show is nearly as effective as Feynman's solution.

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Rethinking energy transition strategies for the European Union amid rising energy prices

2026-06-01 · DOI 10.1073/PNAS.2609606123

Wenjun Meng; Jaime Nieto; Dabo Guan; Jing Meng; Robert Sander; Ulrich Poschl; Klaus Hubacek; Hang Su; Shu Tao; Yafang Cheng

Aerosol Chemistry Department, Max Planck Institute for Chemistry; College of Urban and Environmental Sciences, Peking University; Department of Earth System Science, Tsinghua University; Institute of Atmospheric Physics, Chinese Academy of Sciences; Integrated Research on Energy, Environment and Society, Energy and Sustainability Research Institute Groningen, University of Groningen; International Institute for Applied Systems Analysis; Multiphase Chemistry Department, Max Planck Institute for Chemistry; Research Group on Energy, Economy and System Dynamics, Escuela de Ingenierías Industriales, University of Valladolid; et al. (10 total)

Abstract. Geopolitical tensions and the disruption of major energy imports have sharply elevated energy prices across the European Union (EU), creating a persistent energy supply gap and posing long-term challenges for energy security. Here, we introduce a comprehensive framework integrating the advanced Greenhouse Gas and Air Pollution Interactions and Synergies (GAINS) model with a system dynamic WILLIAM ("Within limits") Integrated Assessment Model to systematically evaluate strategies for closing this energy gap. We find that measures to close the energy gap in the short term exacerbate either economic or public health burdens, highlighting the need for more sustainable solutions in the long term. Our further analysis shows that long-term strategies focused on renewable energy transitions not only close the energy gap but also bring net benefits equivalent to ~3% of projected GDP for 2050. Moreover, we find that rising energy prices substantially influence the cost-effectiveness of accelerated energy transitions. Under current high energy price levels, the benefits from achieving energy targets set for 2050 by 5 to 20 y in advance could outweigh the additional costs. The consideration of dynamic trends in the levelized cost of electricity (LCOE), particularly under rapid renewables expansion, is critical for avoiding overly optimistic estimations of green transition benefits. Our findings suggest that a timely transition to renewable energy benefits the EU in the face of the energy crisis, and policies proactively adjusting energy prices could facilitate a greener, more sustainable future.

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The 2025-2030 Dietary Guidelines for Americans are associated with higher land, water and nitrogen use, and greenhouse gas emissions

2026-06-01 · DOI 10.1073/PNAS.2604814123

Alon Shepon; Tamar Makov; David L. Katz; Gidon Eshel

Department of Environmental Physics, Bard College; DietID; Management Department, Ben-Gurion University of the Negev; School of Sustainability and Climate Change, Ben-Gurion University of the Negev; The Department of Public Policy, Social Sciences Faculty, Tel Aviv University; The Steinhardt Museum of Natural History, Tel Aviv University

Abstract. Dietary guidelines form the foundation of federal food policy, informing programs such as the Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program (SNAP), government food procurement, school meals, and military and hospital food services. The most recent guidelines, released in early 2026, advise avoiding "hyperprocessed" (generally known as ultraprocessed foods, UPFs), while also recommending higher overall protein intake chiefly from animal sources. Here, we quantified the greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions, freshwater use, land use, and nitrogen fertilizer use of adherence to these new guidelines in comparison to the current Mean American Diet (MAD). We constructed isocaloric diets with varying degrees of added protein intake and protein sources that are similar to current dietary patterns, but with no UPFs as recommended. We find that although eliminating ultraprocessed foods from the MAD could yield substantial environmental benefits-given their large share of total intake and animal-based makeup-the recommended increase in animal-based proteins, will more than offset this environmental dividend in GHG, land use, and nitrogen fertilizer use by as much as 32%, but not in water use (i.e., water use is lower by 7 to 19% than the MAD). Across all environmental metrics measured, favoring plants- over animal-based foods leads to better environmental outcomes. Overall, adherence to the 2025-2030 Dietary Guidelines for Americans would confer net environmental harm across most key metrics relative to the prevailing U.S. diet.

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Previous Week Catch-Up

Journal of Communication

Modes of dialogic communication, modes of reality

2026-05-29 · DOI 10.1093/JOC/JQAG006

Boris H J M Brummans

Department of Communication, Universite de Montreal , Montreal, QC,

Abstract. Abstract What if dialogue didn't begin with individuals trying to connect, but with a deeper connectedness already unfolding? This theoretical essay explores that question by introducing two modes of dialogic communication, each expressing the ground of experience in a distinct way. Drawing on Buddhist philosophy, particularly Dzogchen, process philosophy, and traditions of dialogic thought, it proposes awaring as the emergent process through which the ground of experience arises. In the dialogue mode, grasping at this unfolding reinforces separation, making reality appear as an exchange between distinct selves seeking understanding. In the dialoguing mode, we recognize the ground's inherent openness, in which voices, gestures, thoughts, and silences co-arise, making reality appear more spacious, relational, and compassionate. Structured in three spiraling movements (ground: awaring, expression: dialoguing, and fruit: recognizing), the essay culminates in a generative conversation with Arnett, Bencherki and Senac, Cooren, and Peters, inviting a reimagining of dialogic communication theory and a deepened study of communicative relationality.

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Technology and face-to-face integration in daily life: an intensive longitudinal study of communication interdependence

2026-05-25 · DOI 10.1093/JOC/JQAG005

Liesel L Sharabi; Elizabeth Dorrance-Hall; John P Caughlin; Alan K Goodboy; Rebekah M Chiasson

Department of Communication Studies, West Virginia University, Morgantown, WV, United States; Department of Communication, Michigan State University , East Lansing, MI.; Department of Communication, University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign, Urbana, IL, United States; Department of Marketing, Agribusiness, and Supply Chain Management, University of Nebraska Kearney, Kearney, NE, United States; Hugh Downs School of Human Communication, Arizona State University , Tempe, AZ,

Abstract. Abstract The current study advances the communication interdependence perspective (CIP) using an intensive longitudinal design and recent refinements in the conceptualization of integration (i.e., how various channels are interconnected). U.S. adults in romantic relationships (N = 175) completed a baseline questionnaire, and then, provided daily diary data over 30 days (4,806 total observations), which we analyzed with dynamic structural equation modeling. Consistent with the CIP, for the typical person, constructive integration had a positive within-person effect (i.e., people felt closer on days that they had more constructive integration than usual) and a positive between-person association (i.e., people with more constructive integration reported more relational closeness on average across the month). Additionally, there was persistence in constructive integration, and persistence was stronger for people who reported more habitual patterns of integration earlier in the month. We discuss the implications for the CIP and for understanding how people mix media in daily life.

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Political Communication

Moving Targets, Moving Politics: The State of Play in Social Media Data Access

2026-05-30 · DOI 10.1080/10584609.2026.2681041

Claes H. de Vreese; Rebekah Tromble

Northeastern University; Universiteit van Amsterdam

Abstract. Abstract unavailable.

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The Prevalence and Consequences of Women's Algorithmic Underrepresentation in Cross-National Political Google Searches

2026-05-27 · DOI 10.1080/10584609.2026.2679476

Tobias Rohrbach; Mykola Makhortykh; Maryna Sydorova

University of Bern; University of Fribourg

Abstract. Abstract unavailable.

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Nature

Redesigning algorithms to intervene on social norm misperceptions during a national election

2026-05-27 · DOI 10.1038/S41586-026-10536-1

William J. Brady; Meriel Doyle; Abdo Elnakouri; Eli J. Finkel; Joshua Conrad Jackson; Nour Kteily; Victoria Parker; Curtis Puryear; Trevor Spelman; Jacob Teeny; Mark Torres

Abstract. Abstract unavailable.

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Socialmedia feeds are detoxified by a redesigned algorithm

2026-05-27 · DOI 10.1038/D41586-026-01636-Z

Abstract. A large-scale experiment tested the impact of changing the Bluesky feed-ranking algorithm on political content and perceptions during the 2024 US presidential election. By making feeds more representative of users, the 'diversified extremity' algorithm reduced exposure to polarizing content and made perceptions of social norms more accurate, without reducing user enjoyment. Reverse-chronological and 'diversified extremity' feeds result in less uncivil content than the current engagement-based model.

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Technology mediation in child sexual exploitation and abuse in Africa and Asia

2026-05-27 · DOI 10.1038/S41586-026-10525-4

Sakshi Ghai; Matti Vuorre; Daniel Kardefelt-Winther; Amanda M. Ferguson; Sebastian Kurten; Sonia Livingstone; Andrew K. Przybylski; Amy Orben

Abstract. Abstract As digital access expands rapidly among children worldwide, technology-facilitated child sexual exploitation and abuse (CSEA), including online grooming, sexual solicitation, non-consensual image sharing and sexual extortion, has emerged as urgent yet underexamined category of digital harms 1 . Despite growing policy attention to online safety, evidence remains limited, particularly in low- and middle-income countries, where most of the world's children live 2 . We analysed nationally representative survey data from 11,912 children aged 12-17 years across 12 countries in eastern and southern Africa and Southeast Asia, collected through the Disrupting Harm project in 2020-2021. We found that one in six internet-using children experienced at least one form of technology-facilitated CSEA, equivalent to over 10 million children. Despite this scale, many experiences went undisclosed, pointing to disclosure as a critical pathway for protection in the digital age. When children did disclose, they relied primarily on informal channels, especially friends, rather than formal reporting mechanisms such as police or helplines. Using Bayesian hierarchical models accounting for cross-country heterogeneity, we

find that older children were less likely to disclose, whereas enabling parental mediation of online activities and children's knowledge of where to seek help after sexual harassment or assault were associated with higher rates of disclosure. These findings provide population-level evidence to inform prevention and response across low- and middle-income countries, where coordinated action by policymakers, law enforcement and technology companies is urgently needed to protect all children.

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Conservation gains should not be at the mercy of political changes

2026-05-26 · DOI 10.1038/D41586-026-01665-8

Juan F. Ovalle; Dylan Craven

Abstract. Abstract unavailable.

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Nature Human Behaviour

Methodological considerations for evaluating policy impacts on transgender and non-binary youth suicidality

2026-05-28 · DOI 10.1038/S41562-026-02467-8

J. Cohn; Peter Sim; Kathleen F. Kerr

Abstract. Abstract unavailable.

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Nature Machine Intelligence

Human-AI interactions reshape the self and our social networks

2026-05-28 · DOI 10.1038/S42256-026-01248-2

Andreia Sofia Teixeira; Sukhwinder Singh Shergill; Guy Laban

Abstract. Abstract unavailable.

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Nature Communications

Critical misalignments in climate pledges reveal imbalanced sustainable development pathways

2026-05-27 · DOI 10.1038/S41467-026-73564-5

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Abstract. Abstract We explore the integration of climate action and Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) in the first two submissions of nationally determined contributions (NDCs) using an AI-based, human-validated framework. Our goal is to provide ex-ante evidence relevant to assessing policy adequacy. We find disparities in topics of interest with high-income countries emphasizing systemic challenges (health, SDG3) and low-income nations prioritizing the water-energy-food nexus (SDGs 6-7-12) and natural resource management (SDG15). We discuss what these diverging development trajectories imply for the Paris Agreement and the 2030 Agenda for sustainable development in terms of global inequality, sustainable finance

flows and multilateral governance.

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Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences

The cost of caring: Gendered health and labor market effects of grandparenthood

2026-05-29 · DOI 10.1073/PNAS.2535409123

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Abstract. While the effects of the transition to parenthood are well researched, less is known about how the transition to grandparenthood affects health and labor market outcomes. Using comprehensive Norwegian register data covering the entire population born between 1950 and 1960, we examine the effects of first-born grandchildren born during 2007-2018. Employing event-study models with person-year records, we compare grandparents to not-yet grandparents. Our findings reveal a sharp increase in the likelihood of respiratory infections during the first two years of grandparenthood, with infections increasing by 56% for women and 31% for men. Additionally, grandparenthood modestly reduces the likelihood of doctor's visits related to mental disorders (4.5%) and cardiovascular health (3.3%). Grandmothers also see a decline in musculoskeletal-related visits (3.8%). These health-related changes coincide with notable gendered effects on labor market participation. Ten years after the birth of their first grandchild, employed women are 12% less likely to hold full-time positions compared to a 2% reduction for men. Overall, our findings demonstrate that the transition to grandparenthood significantly reshapes health and economic outcomes for both women and men. The larger effects observed for women likely reflect their greater involvement in informal childcare provision. Our results underscore the intersection of health, family dynamics, and gendered labor market behaviors in late adulthood.

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The diffusion of large language models in published academic articles

2026-05-29 · DOI 10.1073/PNAS.2605754123

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Abstract. Large language models (LLMs) are rapidly changing academic research, raising questions of who is adopting these tools and under what conditions. This article analyzes full texts of 7.3 million journal articles published from 2020-2025 by four major publishers (Elsevier, Frontiers, MDPI, and PLoS) to track the prevalence of LLM-associated language and identify social and institutional correlates of adoption. A corpus of 228 focal words exhibiting sharp post-2022 frequency increases consistent with LLM output was developed; articles were scored on their rate of focal word usage. By 2025, an estimated 57% of published articles exhibited evidence of LLM influence, up from 12% in 2023. Among articles exhibiting LLM-influenced text, there is substantial heterogeneity, ranging from subtle linguistic influence to articles mostly or entirely LLM-generated. Difference-in-differences models reveal that LLM-associated language varies markedly across regions, institutional ranks, publishers, disciplines, and journal tiers. Economic development and proximity to English as a primary language are key predictors of regional variation. Lower-ranked institutions exhibit higher rates than elite universities, young for-profit publishers show elevated rates vis-a-vis competitors, and academic fields differ widely in adoption. LLM adoption in academic writing is pervasive but socially stratified. As models grow more powerful and their use becomes further entrenched in academic research, understanding social dynamics of adoption will be essential for governing the evolving relationship between AI and academic knowledge production.

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What leads to administrative bloat? A dynamic model of administrative cost and waste

2026-05-29 · DOI 10.1073/PNAS.2527106123

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Abstract. The functioning of complex systems depends on the coordination of diverse components, often supported by regulatory structures that incur costs. In human organizations, such costs manifest as administrative burden, which has been rising despite often reducing efficiency. Classic explanations point to bureaucrat self-interest or regulation, yet they do not explain variation across organizations or clarify how this burden can be reduced. Here, we develop a dynamical model of administrative growth that integrates known behavioral mechanisms of process creation, obsolescence, and removal. The model conceptualizes processes as developed for problem solving, but becoming obsolete as conditions change, while continuing to consume resources until actively pruned. This interplay generates two long-term outcomes: stable equilibrium or run-away growth. The threshold separating these outcomes is shaped by organizations' propensity to create new processes when faced with problems, and their propensity to prune obsolete ones in response to administrative burden. Importantly, their effects are asymmetric: Sufficiently high creation propensity leads to bloat regardless of pruning propensity. Faster environmental change shifts this threshold, making bloat more likely. Simulations of interventions show that lasting reductions in administrative costs and waste require permanent shifts in priorities and investments in distinguishing obsolete from useful processes. Temporary efforts or indiscriminate cuts provide only short-lived relief, and counterintuitively, prioritizing direct production can increase waste. Our work highlights a general mechanism by which well-intentioned problem-solving can create self-reinforcing inefficiencies in complex systems, offering insights possibly generalizable to broader applications, such as legal, policy, and software systems where obsolete elements accumulate.

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AI-assisted teams outperform AI-led teams but not human-only teams in assessing research reproducibility in quantitative social science

2026-05-28 · DOI 10.1073/PNAS.2524747123

Abel Brodeur; David Valenta; Alexandru Marcoci; Juan P. Aparicio; Derek Mikola; Bruno Barbarioli; Rohan Alexander; Lachlan Deer; Tom Stafford; Lars Vilhuber; Gunther Bensch; Fabio Motoki; et al. (272 total)

Aalto University; Agri-Science Queensland, Department of Primary Industries, Brisbane; Applied Economics and Management, Cornell University; Applied Economics, University of Minnesota; Asia and Pacific Department, International Monetary Fund; Bart's Life Sciences, Bart's Health National Health Services Trust; Behavioral Science, Geary Institute for Public Policy; Beijing Normal University, Belt and Road School; et al. (254 total)

Abstract. Large Language Models (LLMs) such as ChatGPT are transforming how scientists conduct and validate research, offering promise as tools to improve scientific reproducibility. However, computational reproducibility and error detection remain expensive and labor-intensive. We experimentally test how collaboration between researchers and LLM assistants influences the reproduction of quantitative social science findings across different levels of AI autonomy. We randomly assigned 288 researchers to 103 teams working under three conditions: human-only, AI-assisted (using ChatGPT as a collaborative tool), or AI-led (ChatGPT operating with minimal human oversight). Teams reproduced published results from leading social science journals, detected coding errors, and proposed robustness checks. Human-only and AI-assisted teams achieved comparable reproduction rates (94% vs. 91%) and performed similarly on most outcomes, except human-only teams identified significantly more major coding errors. Both substantially outperformed AI-led teams, which achieved only a 37% reproduction rate, detected fewer errors across all categories, proposed weaker robustness checks, and required more time. This autonomous approach, however, likely represents only a lower bound of AI capabilities. Despite rapid model advances, expert human judgment currently remains indispensable for reliable empirical verification. While AI assistance did not degrade most outcomes, it provided no measurable advantages and was associated with reduced detection of major

errors. However, the 37% autonomous reproduction rate indicates that AI could provide value in settings where scale or cost constraints preclude human review of papers, even though general-purpose LLMs offer no immediate advantages for human-supervised verification.

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Early neural attunement to peer status predicts future social network position and popularity in adolescents

2026-05-27 · DOI 10.1073/PNAS.2536452123

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Abstract. Popularity is a key marker of social status, yet the phenomena that support its emergence within newly forming social groups remain unclear. We combined functional neuroimaging and longitudinal school-wide social network analysis to track adolescents throughout their first year of high school, examining whether early neural responses to peers of varying social status predict later popularity. Here, we show that greater neural differentiation when viewing the faces of unpopular versus popular peers, particularly in the hippocampus, forecasts greater perceived popularity at the end of the school year. This relationship is mediated by midyear social network centrality, especially in-closeness centrality, which reflects being more easily reachable by peers. These findings suggest that early neural attunement to the status of their peers shapes how adolescents become embedded in their social networks, which in turn contributes to later gains in their own perceived popularity. More generally, these findings reveal how neural and social network-level processes jointly drive adolescents' navigation of evolving social landscapes and attainment of social status.

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Neural representations of popularity and leadership status relate to conformity in daily life

2026-05-27 · DOI 10.1073/PNAS.2526584123

Ovidia A. Stanoi; Danielle Cosme; Mia Jovanova; Yoona Kang; Faustine Corbani; Amanda L. McGowan; Jose Carreras-Tartak; Anthony Resnick; Peter S. Bearman; Zachary M. Boyd; Dani S. Bassett; David M. Lydon-Staley; et al. (15 total)

Annenberg Public Policy Center, University of Pennsylvania; Annenberg School for Communication, University of Pennsylvania; Centre for Digital Health Interventions, Department of Management, Technology and Economics, ETH Zurich; Department of Bioengineering, University of Pennsylvania; Department of Mathematics, Brigham Young University; Department of Mathematics, Dartmouth College; Department of Psychology, Columbia University; Department of Psychology, Princeton University; et al. (13 total)

Abstract. Individuals are motivated to increase their social status. To succeed in this pursuit, people must track information about others in their social sphere, monitor group norms, and adjust their behavior strategically. This study employed functional MRI and ecological momentary assessment methods in a sample of 92 college students belonging to 9 social groups to elucidate the neural mechanisms underlying these processes and their relationship to conformity in the context of alcohol use. When young adults passively looked at faces of their real-life social group peers, brain systems implicated in valuation and social cognition spontaneously tracked information about the popularity and leadership status of the social targets in an interdependent manner. Individual differences in these neural valuations were systematically associated with varying levels of conformity. Students who had stronger responses to faces of peers with relatively higher popularity and leadership status than themselves in one key valuation brain region, the ventromedial prefrontal cortex (vmPFC), were more likely to align their drinking behavior with their groups' norms in everyday life. These results provide evidence for how brain systems involved in valuation and social cognition flexibly track information about peers' popularity and leadership status in real-life social groups and contribute to a growing literature on the neural mechanisms through which social comparison processes shape conformity. Our study highlights the vmPFC as a central hub that spontaneously tracks status differences between the self and peers and uses this information to guide behavior to match group norms.

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Peer influence on West Point cadets' Civil War allegiances

2026-05-27 · DOI 10.1073/PNAS.2529668123

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Abstract. Do social networks and peer influence shape major life decisions in polarized settings? We explore this question by examining how peers influenced the allegiances of West Point cadets during the American Civil War. Leveraging quasi-random variations in the proportion of cadets from Free States, we analyze how cadets' decisions about which army to join depended on the composition of their peers. We have three main findings. First, there was a strong and significant peer effect: a higher proportion of classmates from Free States significantly increased the likelihood that cadets from Slave States joined the Union Army. Second, the peer effect varies with geography, most notably with the slave population share in cadets' home states or counties, and with cadets' own slave ownership in 1860. Third, peer effects were amplified by shared experiences such as having served together in the Mexican-American War, continuous military service, and belonging to the same cohort, suggesting that sustained interaction is important.

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Accessibility-equality dynamics in urban blue and green spaces reshape human well-being

2026-05-26 · DOI 10.1073/PNAS.2535714123

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Abstract. As urbanization accelerates, urban blue and green spaces are increasingly recognized as critical nature-based solutions for enhancing human well-being, delivering climate, environmental, and psychological benefits. Yet, the mechanisms by which access to these natural spaces and the equality of access by urbanites in diverse residential locations shape well-being remain poorly understood in the context of sustainable urban governance. Here, we systematically evaluated the spatiotemporal dynamics of urban blue and green space accessibility and equality across 279 Chinese cities from 2000-2100 and assessed their combined effects on well-being. We found that accessibility has a significant positive influence on well-being but follows an inverted-U-shaped pattern with distinct optimal thresholds. By contrast, equality shows a consistent, positive linear relationship with well-being. Although future accessibility is projected to improve, persistently high disparities among different segments of urban populations highlight the urgent need for equity-centered governance of blue and green spaces in cities. This perspective extends current approaches to environmental justice while revealing a structural mismatch between resource abundance and equitable distribution. To address this mismatch, we propose a prioritization framework that emphasizes context-specific, spatially targeted interventions, guided by four key drivers: the natural space to built-up area ratio, urban population size, the proportion of natural spaces with high accessibility, and urban landscape connectivity. By operationalizing these insights in an online toolkit for local governments, this work advances the fields of sustainable urban governance and equitable environmental planning.

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China's one-child policy amplifies intergenerational inequality via enlarged differential fertility

2026-05-26 · DOI 10.1073/PNAS.2525381123

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Abstract. Using the staggered rollout of China's one-child policy (OCP) across provinces and birth cohorts as a quasi-natural experiment, we demonstrate that differential fertility between richer and poorer households exacerbates intergenerational income inequality. Rural/poorer families, who are less constrained by the OCP than their urban/richer counterparts, tend to have more children but invest less in each child's human capital. This reduction in mobility is primarily driven by the rising economic status of children born to urban/wealthier families. Our estimates suggest that the OCP accounts for approximately 25% of the observed decline in intergenerational income mobility in China and thus highlight a demographic channel through which economic inequality persists across generations.

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Emerging design principles for environmental, economic, and equity successes in land conservation

2026-05-26 · DOI 10.1073/PNAS.2421731122

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Abstract. Land conservation initiatives worldwide are poised to continue rapid growth. Ranging in scale, scope, and mechanisms, these efforts include area-based conservation, incentive-based protection, and community collective management. Evidence from across fields now indicates that it is possible for land conservation to jointly improve environmental conditions, generate positive net local economic benefits, and support social equity. Yet the key policy elements that can lead to this type of multidimensional success are not well understood. Here, we review the considerable body of existing research on land conservation and propose eight emerging design principles that conservation actors can employ to support "win-win-win" outcomes: 1) identify and support credible pathways of change, 2) set goals for all outcomes, recognizing their interdependencies, 3) accommodate multiple needs and uses through spatial or place-specific differentiation, 4) facilitate temporal resilience through diversification and limits, 5) foster nested governance, 6) integrate information structures for environmental and social outcomes, 7) assess policies using counterfactual-based analysis and adaptive management, 8) establish lasting institutions and funding mechanisms. Although these design principles will likely change and evolve, they provide an evidence-grounded framework to support current and future efforts to steward global lands.

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Rational sycophants and catastrophic risks

2026-05-26 · DOI 10.1073/PNAS.2537944123

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Abstract. Sycophants praise and support leaders' proposals to gain personal and professional advantage. A rational sycophant is an advisor who supports actions they expect to be harmful even when rewards and punishments for good and bad advice are equal in magnitude. Rational sycophancy arises when the outcome distribution of a proposed action has a negative expected value but a positive median (outcome asymmetry). The risk is greatest when a small yet meaningful fraction of outcomes are catastrophic, which occurs in long-tailed distributions. Given that single realizations from long-tailed distributions reveal little about the underlying distribution, even after outcomes are observed, a leader may be unable to distinguish rational sycophancy from wise counsel. As a result, rational sycophants may gain influence and increase the likelihood of catastrophic policy outcomes.

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Semantic knowledge guides innovation and drives cultural evolution

2026-05-26 · DOI 10.1073/PNAS.2530750123

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Abstract. Cultural evolution allows ideas and technologies to accumulate across generations, reaching their most complex and open-ended form in humans. While social learning enables the transmission of such innovations, the cognitive processes that generate them remain poorly understood. Classical theories typically treat innovation as random variation, a simplification insufficient for explaining the complexity of human cultural evolution. We propose that semantic knowledge-the associations linking concepts to their properties and functions-guides human innovation and drives cumulative culture. To test this, we combined an agent-based model, which examines how semantic knowledge shapes cultural evolutionary dynamics, with a large-scale behavioral experiment (N = 1,243) testing its role in human innovation. Across both approaches, we found that semantic knowledge directed exploration toward meaningful solutions, enhanced innovation success, and enabled generalization from prior discoveries. Moreover, semantic knowledge interacted synergistically with social learning to amplify innovation and accelerate cumulative cultural change. In contrast, experimental participants lacking access to semantic knowledge performed no better than chance, even when social learning was possible, and relied on shallow exploration strategies for innovation. Together, these findings suggest that semantic knowledge is a key cognitive process underpinning human cumulative culture.

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Science

Volatile food trade policy threatens biodiversity

2026-05-28 · DOI 10.1126/SCIENCE.AEH4080

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Abstract. Abstract unavailable.

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Science Advances

Which immigrants do citizens prefer? A meta-reanalysis of 100 conjoint experiments

2026-05-29 · DOI 10.1126/SCIADV.ADZ2271

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Abstract. In the past decade, an important literature in the social sciences has examined public attitudes toward immigrants in host societies. In it, a prominent experimental method-the conjoint design, where participants are tasked with rating or choosing between randomized profiles-has been used reliably to understand how immigrant characteristics shape admission preferences. We collate replication datasets from 100 individual studies spanning 1,475,403 immigrant profiles with 26 randomized attributes evaluated by 142,817 survey respondents from 36 countries. Meta-analyses reinforce well-established findings: Economic, cultural, humanitarian, and procedural factors all influence evaluations. Meta-reanalyses show that

preferences are broadly similar across countries and demographic groups. However, they also reveal two additional patterns: Economic considerations have become more influential over time, and evaluations of individual immigrants differ sharply depending on where people stand on the broader immigration debate. These findings shed light on ongoing debates and point to fruitful areas for future research.

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